

The *Campus Visit* Kit

What to do before, during and after a college visit, with the questions most families forget to ask.

1 Before you go

- ☐ Register for the official tour and information session on the school's admissions site
- ☐ Ask whether you can sit in on a class or meet someone from your student's intended major
- ☐ Check whether the school tracks visits as "demonstrated interest"
- ☐ Have your student write down three things they want to find out

2 Questions to ask

Admissions

What does a typical admitted student look like here?

How do you review applications: grades, rigor, essays, activities?

Are test scores required, optional or recommended?

How do you use self-reported grades?

Current students

What do you wish you had known before coming here?

How easy is it to get the classes you need?

What do people do on weekends?

How hard was it to find housing after freshman year?

Financial aid

What percent of need do you typically meet?

Do merit scholarships need a separate application?

How does Bright Futures work with your aid package?

What do students actually pay after aid, on average?

Your major

How big are classes in the first two years?

Are there internships, research or co-ops?

Where do graduates in this major work?

Is it hard to get into the major once enrolled?

3 Compare up to three schools

	School 1	School 2	School 3
Academics / majors			
Class size			
Campus feel			
Housing			
Food			
Clubs & activities			
Safety			
Distance from home			
Estimated cost after aid			
Gut feeling (1–5)			

4 Right after the visit

- ☐ Have your student write three things they loved and one thing they didn't, the same day
- ☐ Save the admissions rep's name and email
- ☐ Note anything to mention in a "Why this school?" essay